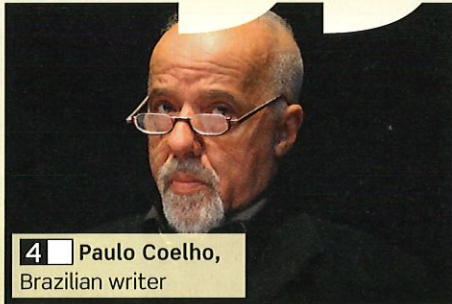


d Talk in small groups.

- 1 From reading the text, what impression do you get of the four people's personalities?
- 2 Which of them do you most identify with? Why?
- 3 What or who motivates you...?
 - in your work or studies
 - to improve your English
 - to improve other skills, e.g., sports, music, other activities (give examples)



4 **Paulo Coelho,**
Brazilian writer

The family is a microcosm of society. It's where your spirit and beliefs are first tested. My mother and father wanted only the best for me and my sister, but had very rigid ideas of what that "best" should be. For me to become a lawyer or even an engineer would have satisfied them, but a writer? Never. I was a determined and rebellious kid, though, and having failed to change my mind by conventional methods, they looked for more dramatic and extreme ones. **In a sense**, though, I thank them for that. I wouldn't have gotten where I am without fighting to live the life I wanted for myself. I long since forgave them. We all make mistakes, parents included.

LEXIS IN CONTEXT

- e Look at the **highlighted** phrases and guess the meaning of the ones you don't know from the context. Then match them with the definitions 1–7.
- 1 _____ to know what you want or like
 - 2 _____ **IDM** (informal) to refuse to change your mind about sth even when other people are trying to persuade you that you are wrong
 - 3 _____ in one way
 - 4 _____ (colloquial) the working or living environment in which we feel safe and unthreatened
 - 5 _____ **IDM** to be determined to continue to do sth in a difficult or unpleasant situation
 - 6 **fill sb in (on)** **PHRV** to tell sb about what has happened
 - 7 _____ **PHRV** (with sb) to reach the same level or standard as sb who is better or more advanced
- f Choose five more words or phrases from the text that you think are useful.
- g Read the information about looking up idioms in a dictionary.

Looking up idioms in a dictionary

You can usually find the definition of an idiom under one of its "full" words (nouns, verbs, adverbs or adjectives, but NOT prepositions and articles), in a section marked, for example, **IDM**. So the definition of *stick to your guns* will probably be given under *stick* or *guns*.

⚠ After some very common verbs, e.g., *be*, *get* and adjectives, e.g., *good*, *bad*, the idioms are usually under the entries for the next "full" word.

Phrasal verbs **PHRV** are always after the main verb, e.g., *get back* and *get over* would be under *get*.

- h Now look at the following idioms with *mind*. What do you think they mean? Check with a dictionary.
- | | |
|-----------------|---------------------------|
| speak your mind | mind your own business |
| cross your mind | be of two minds about sth |

2 GRAMMAR discourse markers (1): connectors

- a Without looking back at the text, with a partner try to remember how these sentences continue. Don't worry if you can't remember the exact words.
- 1 **Ann Patchett**: "I learned to read late, and **as a result**..."
 - 2 **John Malkovich**: "It would sometimes amuse my brother and his friends to throw cans at me. Why? **Because of**..."
 - 3 **Marcus Wareing**: "But I did come to London, and **even though**..., I worked like a real trouser and was very quick to learn."
 - 4 **Marcus Wareing**: "So I called my dad every day, **to**..."
- b Compare your answers with the text.
- c Which of the **bold** connectors in **a** introduces...?
- | | |
|-------------------------------|--------------------|
| 1 a result <u>as a result</u> | 3 a purpose _____ |
| 2 a reason _____ | 4 a contrast _____ |
- d ➤ **p.138 Grammar Bank 1A**. Learn more about connectors, and practice them.
- e ① 2))) Listen to the sentences. When the speakers pause, write down how you think the sentences might continue.
- f ① 3))) Now listen to the whole sentences. Are they similar to what you wrote?